

Who Got to Roar

The Roaring Twenties · 1920–1929 | Standards US.28, US.29, US.30, US.31, US.32, US.33, US.34, US.35, US.36, US.37, US.38

Name _____

- Archive (J. Troop)
- Spark
- Navigator
- Notetaker

ESSENTIAL QUESTION

The 1920s are remembered as one long party — jazz, cars, radio, and easy money. But a decade can roar for some people while it slams the door on others. Who actually got to roar in the Twenties, who got shut out, and was a country changing this fast becoming freer — or just louder?

Hold this question the whole unit. You'll answer it at the end — in your own words, from the evidence.

1 Mission Vocabulary

Write what each word means as you meet it in the stories.

Great Migration	_____	Harlem Renaissance	_____
	_____		_____
mass culture	_____	flapper	_____
	_____		_____
fundamentalism vs. modernism	_____	Prohibition	_____
	_____		_____
buying on margin	_____	nativism	_____
	_____		_____

2 Flight Log — every stop

One entry per landing. Jot what you *notice*, then answer the crew's debrief — the point isn't a right answer, it's your read of the evidence.

#	What Spark shows you & the crew's debrief	Your read & evidence
1	Analyze the causes and effects of the Great Migration, and how it fed the Harlem Renaissance's celebration of Black identity. Notice: Imagine leaving the only home you've ever known — not for a vacation, but because staying could get you killed. You pack one suitcase, board a... Debrief: Explain the Great Migration using push and pull factors, then explain how it connected to the Harlem Renaissance. Use one piece of evidence (a source or figure) from the spread.	
2	Explain how radio spread American music nationwide, making Nashville the capital of country music and carrying the blues into the mainstream. Notice: Your favorite song right now — how did you find it? A stream, an algorithm, a phone. Now erase all of that. In 1925 a brand-new machine did... Debrief: Explain how radio changed American music in the 1920s, and give one example each of how it spread country music and the blues. Why is Tennessee central to this story?	
3	Analyze how radio and film, new technologies (aviation, electricity), and Ford's assembly line created a modern mass-consumer society. Notice: One man flies alone across an entire ocean, and by the time he lands, the whole planet already knows his name — because a new machine carried the... Debrief: Choose two of these — radio/film, aviation or electrification, or the automobile — and explain how each made American life more modern in the 1920s. Include one cost or trade-off.	
4	Analyze the changing roles and status of women in the 1920s — flappers, the birth-control movement, and the limits that remained. Notice: Cut your hair short. Wear what you want. Go out without asking permission. Get a job, spend your own money, and dance to music your grandmother... Debrief: Describe two ways women's lives changed in the 1920s and two limits that remained. Was the 'new woman' mostly real freedom or mostly hype? Defend your answer with evidence.	
5	Analyze the civil-liberties and civil-rights challenges of the 1920s — the Red Scare, the Klan's resurgence, the Tulsa massacre, and immigration... Notice: A country gets scared. Scared of radicals, scared of immigrants, scared of anyone who looks or prays or votes differently. And instead of talking... Debrief: Identify three examples of intolerance or civil-liberties violations in the 1920s, then explain how Americans organized to resist. Why might these events have been left out of the 'Roaring Twenties' story for so long?	
6	Analyze Prohibition — its goals, its unintended consequences (organized crime), and its ultimate failure and repeal. Notice: What happens when you make something illegal that millions of people refuse to stop wanting? You don't end it — you just hand the whole business... Debrief: Explain why many Americans supported Prohibition, then explain its main unintended consequences and why it was repealed. What general lesson does Prohibition teach about laws?	
7	Analyze the Scopes Trial as a dramatization of the clash between fundamentalism and modernism — staged in Dayton, Tennessee. Notice: A small Tennessee town. A young teacher. A law that makes it a crime to teach where humans came from. In the summer of 1925, the whole country —... Debrief: Explain what the Scopes Trial was about and why it mattered beyond one teacher. Represent both Bryan's and Darrow's positions fairly, then explain why historians say 'no one really won.'	
8	Analyze the economic weaknesses of the 1920s — easy credit, stock speculation, and inequality — that set up the Great Depression. Notice: Buy it now, pay later. Put ten percent down and borrow the rest. Everyone's getting rich in the stock market, so throw your money in — prices only... Debrief: Explain three economic weaknesses of the 1920s (credit, speculation, inequality) and how each helped set up the Great Depression. Which do you think	

#	What Spark shows you & the crew's debrief	Your read & evidence
	was most dangerous, and why?	

S Source Detective

Find this primary source in Unit 4 of your book, then work it like an investigator: **An African American family of nine, dressed in coats and hats with their suitcases at their feet, photographed shortly after arriving in Chicago during the Great Migration, when hundreds of thousands of Black Americans moved from the rural South to northern cities.**²⁸ on the Great Migration.

1. Who made this, and when? Whose point of view does it show — and whose is missing?
2. Spark's question: *This is a real family, photographed just after arriving in Chicago from the South around 1920 — coats on, suitcases at their feet. Ask: what can...*
3. What does this source prove — and what does it *not* prove on its own?

A The Arc of the Union — *your call*

For each milestone, decide: did it move the country **toward** its founding promise — liberty and equality *for all* — or **away**? There's no answer key. Mark your read and back it with evidence.

Year	Milestone	Toward ↗ or away ↘?	Why — your evidence
1920	Prohibition begins (18th Amendment)		
1921	Tulsa Race Massacre		
1924	National Origins Act restricts immigration		
1925	The Great Migration and Harlem Renaissance		
1925	The Grand Ole Opry puts Nashville on the map		
1925	The Scopes Trial		
1929	The credit boom crests		

B Debrief & Closing Argument

The Twenties are the trickiest decade yet for the 'more perfect union' question, because progress and backlash happen at the exact same time. The...

Closing question: The 1920s advanced some Americans and set others back — often in the very same year. Pick two events from this unit that pulled the country in opposite directions, and use them to argue whether the decade, on balance, moved the United States closer to its founding promise or further from it. Cite the unit. There's no answer key — make the case.

Back to the Essential Question — your answer now: